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TRAFFIC

Helicopter work prompts full Kamehameha Highway closure near Waimea Bay

by: [Emily Cervantes](#)

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WAIMEA BAY, Hawaii (KHON2) — Another closure is coming to Kamehameha Highway as the Department of Transportation continues rockfall mitigation work near Waimea Bay.

Officials said the latest full closure will happen on Sunday, May 17 from 7 a.m. to 5 p.m. so a helicopter can drape rockfall netting over the slope.

Single-lane closure at Waimea Bay to last months after repeated rockfalls >

“This is the first delivery of the 200,000 square foot rockfall protection netting that will cover the slope above Kamehameha Highway,” DOT said. “The rockfall protection netting will be anchored to the slope and supplemented by a 500-foot-long impact fencing system at the bottom of the slope.”

The closure follows a series of dangerous landslides and rockfalls that happened during March’s heavy Kona low conditions, ultimately resulting in the DOT implementing a single-lane closure for the next three to four months.

“Professional rock mitigation crews are working all available daylight hours to stabilize this slope and protect this critical transportation corridor,” officials added. “By maintaining the single lane closure 24/7, the estimated duration of the stabilization project has been reduced by half.”

Heavy traffic expected near Waimea Bay as full closures of Kamehameha Hwy begins ➤

In the meantime, DOT said vehicles may turn around at Iliohu Place on the Haleiwa side and Kapuhi Street/Three Tables on the Kahuku side. Electronic signage will also be posted.

Emergency vehicles and TheBus will be able to pass trthrough the closure area, as long as there is advance coordination.

The DOT thanked North Shore residents and visitors for their patience during the emergency repairs and said the \$34.4 million project is estimated to be completed later this summer.

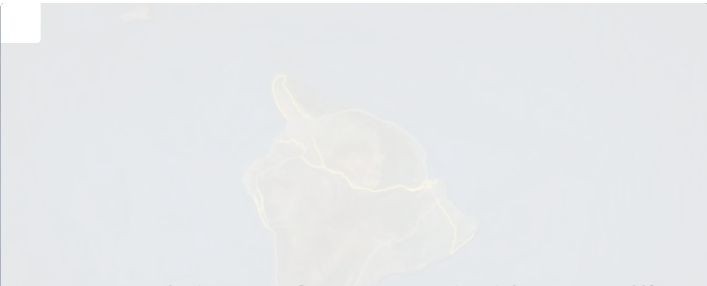
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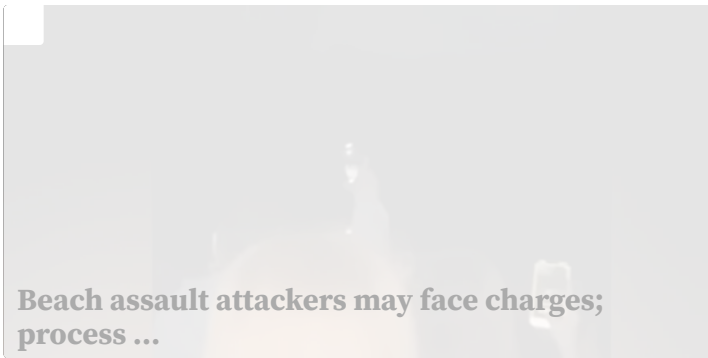
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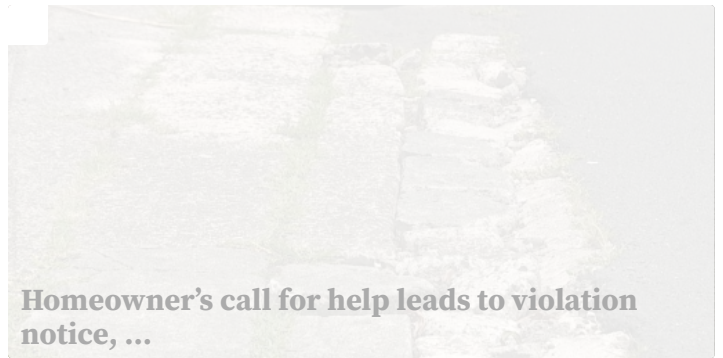
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